

FREE SAMPLE

# White's Tree Frog Care Package

The first 4 pages of the 39-page printable manual, free to keep.



**In this sample:** What's inside, How to Use This Package, Quick Profile & Cost Overview. The contents page shows every one of the 39 pages, so you can see exactly what the full package covers before you buy it.

**Not in this sample:** the 35 pages that follow, which are the full care guide, the health section, the quick reference cards, and the owner tools, checklists and logs.

**The full package** is \$8.99 at [beastlyfacts.com/care-packages/whites-tree-frog/](https://beastlyfacts.com/care-packages/whites-tree-frog/). One purchase, and every corrected edition is a free re-download from your library. The free White's tree frog care guide it was built from is at [beastlyfacts.com/guides/whites-tree-frog/](https://beastlyfacts.com/guides/whites-tree-frog/), and stays free.

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# What's inside

Every page is written to be used, not just read once.

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## START HERE

# How to use this package

Three ways to get value from it, depending on where you are right now.

### If you haven't bought a frog yet

Read pages 4 through 11 in order before buying anything, then the feeding section. Two decisions are the expensive ones to get wrong: the enclosure on page 5, which has to be tall rather than long, and how many frogs you keep on page 16, because when two frogs differ in size, the bigger one may try to swallow the smaller. Settle both, then use the Budget and Shopping List on page 29 to buy once instead of twice.

### If your frog is already home

Start with the Setup Checklist on page 27 to audit what you have. Then read page 8 before you next fill the mister, because untreated tap water and distilled water are both wrong for an animal that drinks and breathes through its skin. Then page 14: obesity is the most common problem in captive adults of this species, and the check takes seconds. If anything already looks wrong, go straight to Health Red Flags on page 20.

### Print these first

- |                                                                    |                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Page 27: Setup Checklist & Targets        | <input type="checkbox"/> Page 34: Pet-Sitter Sheet    |
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#### WHY THIS PACKAGE EXISTS

The White's tree frog is sold as the easy frog, and next to most amphibians it is: calm, sturdy, and one of the few that tolerates being picked up. The trouble is that its easiness gets read as low maintenance. A frog that eats everything offered gets fed everything, a care sheet that says "high humidity" gets followed with an enclosure that never dries, and tap water goes into the mister because it is what comes out of the faucet. Each of those is a common way this species gets sick. Every figure here is cross-checked against veterinary sources, listed on page 38, and every temperature and dimension is given in both imperial and metric.

#### NOT A SUBSTITUTE FOR

A veterinarian who sees amphibians. This is a husbandry reference for day-to-day care, and anything urgent is a professional call, not a page in this book. Amphibian medicine has real limits, which puts most of the weight on getting the setup right, and it also means the vet you need is not the nearest one. Find one before you need one, and write the number on page 28.

## SECTION 01

# Quick profile

Everything at a glance before you read the detail.

|                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scientific name      | <i>Litoria caerulea</i> . Also called the dumpy tree frog or Australian green tree frog. Some recent references file it as <i>Ranoidea caerulea</i>                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Native range         | Northern and eastern Australia and southern New Guinea. Forest and woodland, and often around houses, where lit windows draw insects                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Adult size           | 3 to 4.5 in (7 to 11 cm). Females run larger: about 4 in (10 cm) against a male's 3 in (7.5 cm)                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Captive lifespan     | About 16 years on average, with one recorded at 21 in human care. More conservative figures say 10 to 15-plus. Plan on well over a decade                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Activity             | Nocturnal. Sleeps through the day tucked against cover and hunts in the evening                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Diet                 | Live insects. Crickets as the staple, juveniles fed daily, adults 2 to 3 times a week. Page 12                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Enclosure, one adult | 18×18×24 in (46×46×61 cm), the 24 in being height. 24×18×24 in (61×46×61 cm) for two to four of a similar size                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Temperature          | Cool side 70 to 75°F (21 to 24°C), basking area 80 to 85°F (27 to 29°C), mid-70s°F (about 24°C) at night                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Humidity             | 50 to 60% baseline, misted up to 70 to 80% once or twice a day, then allowed to fall. Page 7                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Water                | Dechlorinated tap or spring water. Never distilled or reverse-osmosis (RO) water. Page 8                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| UVB                  | UVB (ultraviolet B) is the band of ultraviolet light a frog uses to make vitamin D3. Recommended rather than required: a 5 to 7% UVB T5 HO tube, replaced every 6 to 8 months. T5 is the slim fluorescent kind, 5/8 inch across; HO, high output, is the tube format; the 5 to 7% rating is what keeps it gentle. Page 9 |
| Signature risk       | Obesity. Read it off the ridges above the eardrum, not the waistline. Page 14                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Handling             | Tolerated, unusually for a frog. Plain water on your hands, no soap, 5 to 15 minutes, about twice a week at most                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Conservation status  | Least Concern on the IUCN Red List, the global list of species at risk kept by the International Union for Conservation of Nature. Buy captive-bred                                                                                                                                                                      |

## Cost overview

### Initial setup

The frog is \$20 to \$60 for a standard animal, more for a blue or other designer color. Itemized properly, the equipment comes to **\$289 to \$528**, and the terrarium is the biggest single line. With the frog, first supplements and a first vet exam, plan on **\$374 to \$758**. Page 29 has every line.

### Ongoing

Feeders, supplements, UVB tubes and water conditioner run **\$178 to \$360 a year**, about \$15 to \$30 a month, with substrate and a little electricity on top. An exam is \$50 to \$150, and an exotic emergency fee alone often starts around \$250 before any treatment.

### THE NUMBER THAT SHOULD DRIVE THE DECISION

Not the price. The lifespan. A frog bought for a twelve-year-old is very likely still alive when that child is finishing college. The purchase is the cheap part of this animal, and the routine on page 32 is what you are actually signing up for.